been split in at least two dozen factions operating under the TTP banner, which did not strictly follow Hakimullah Mehsud's commands (*The Nation*, 2011).

However, these groups followed the TTP ideology based on anti-Americanism, abhorrence for the US 'war on terror' (which they construe as a war on Islam) and of course the longing for enforcement of *Sharia* in Pakistan. But each component group within the TTP also had its own specific objectives, priorities and approaches depending on its geographical placement and sectarian ideology. Punjabi TTP, Swati TTP, Waziristani TTP and others operated accordingly. There had been clashes between different groups, primarily to take control of respective areas. Aman (Peace) Lashkars formed with the backing of the army often faced attacks from various TTP groups. For example, Tirah Valley in Khyber Agency, close to Duran Line, remained a place of skirmishes between Aman Lashkar and Lashkar-e-Islam (LI) backed by TTP in 2012. Ansar ul Islam (AI), another armed group in the area, sided with Aman Lashkar. LI captured checkposts in Angori Morcha, Bucha, Kala Wuch, Dri Addi, Haidar Kandau and Adam Khel areas. Approximately 23 AI fighters and Aman Lashkar volunteers who were deployed in these posts were killed in these skirmishes. LI lost 45 militants. However, according to official statements, 22 posts were recaptured the very next day (Aziz, 2013).

The TTP leader in Kurram, Fazal Saeed, formed his own group named Tehreek-e-Taliban Islami (TTI). He stated that he had differences with the TTP leadership as he wanted them to stop suicide attacks against mosques, markets and other civilian targets (AFP, 2011).[1] This reason to quit TTP seemed flawed as he had taken responsibility for the bombing of a Shi'a neighbourhood in Parachinar that killed 43 civilians (*Jamestown*, 2012). The plausible reason could be his ambition to form a group of his own, enjoy power and control operational activities. Financial gains and control could be another important reason. Other factions sprung up for similar reasons.

Some insiders also thought that TTP had been fragmented and therefore its strength and effectiveness was considerably depleted.[2] However, they also admitted that due to army operations in South Waziristan, most of the TTP activists had scattered and relocated to other hideouts in North Waziristan and as far as Chaman, Balochistan.